

Chapter 135-1

Moonlight spilled through the window lattice, casting a hazy glow over the plush toys on the bay window.

Only a dim yellow bedside lamp was lit in the room.

Xu Qingzhu's voice was fragmented with sobs, like a homeless cat on a snowy night.

The wind had picked up outside, blowing fine snow. The withered branches, unable to bear the weight, swayed with the wind and shook off the snow that had covered them.

The moment the snow fell, it had the beauty of "as if the Milky Way were tumbling down from the ninth heaven"¹—drifting and scattering, tinged with the silver radiance of moonlight.

The tips of Liang Shi's hair were dampened with Xu Qingzhu's sweat. The room was filled with the rich, lingering scent of strawberry Baileys, mixed with the White Silver Needle tea² fragrance from her body.

To Liang Shi, the sweet strawberry scent was much richer than the tea scent.

But to Xu Qingzhu, the tea fragrance of White Silver Needle was more intense than her own strawberry scent.

It was clearly such a light and ascetic tea fragrance, yet after smelling it, it could stir every cell in her body.

Xu Qingzhu's tears had soaked the pillow.

Outside, a cat from who knows whose home let out a sharp cry, as if someone had stepped on its tail.

It formed an interlocking symphony with the sounds Xu Qingzhu made in the room.

The night gradually deepened.

//

Xu Qingzhu was covered in sweat, as if she had been washed with water. The bed sheets were also sticky.

Liang Shi carried Xu Qingzhu to take a bath.

The bathroom here was small, with no bathtub—they could only shower. But Xu Qingzhu couldn't even stand steadily. When entering the bathroom, her legs went weak and her feet slipped, nearly causing her to fall.

She was casually wearing one of Liang Shi's shirts. There was still some height difference between the two of them.

Though it wasn't too much.

Liang Shi's oversized shirt looked a bit short on Xu Qingzhu, with both slender legs exposed, looking like she was wearing an outfit with a "disappearing bottom half."³

When Xu Qingzhu buttoned the shirt, she did it carelessly, misaligning one button.

The collar on both sides at the top was uneven, as was the bottom.

The top wasn't too bad—just a few strawberry marks.⁴

There were more marks on her legs.

Liang Shi was already considered the gentle type. Before doing anything, she would always ask many questions, afraid that Xu Qingzhu would feel uncomfortable, also afraid she would cry.

She coaxed while doing it, but unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu cried even harder.

If she continued, Xu Qingzhu would cry. If she stopped, she would cry even louder.

When extremely frustrated, she would even bite Liang Shi.

The white shirt was of good quality, but since it was meant for summer wear, it was rather thin.

Everything underneath could be seen clearly.

When water from the showerhead accidentally sprayed on her, the white shirt clung tightly to her skin.

Liang Shi lowered her eyes and silently recited a calming mantra in her heart.

Hot water continuously fell from the showerhead, filling the bathroom with hazy steam.

Xu Qingzhu's hair was also drenched, and Liang Shi couldn't escape either.

Originally, she had only wanted to help Xu Qingzhu take a bath so she could sleep peacefully, but now both of them were completely soaked, so they might as well wash together.

Footnotes:

¹ "疑是银河落九天" - A famous line from the Tang dynasty poet Li Bai's poem "Gazing at the Waterfall on Mount Lu" (望庐山瀑布). The original line describes a waterfall so magnificent it seems like the Milky Way falling from the highest heavens. Here it's used poetically to describe the beautiful sight of snow falling in the moonlight.

² White Silver Needle (白毫銀針, Bái Háo Yín Zhēn) - One of the most prized and expensive white teas from China, known for its delicate, subtle flavor and silvery-white appearance. It's made only from the unopened buds of the tea plant.

³ "下身消失" (disappearing bottom half) - A popular fashion trend/style where someone wears an oversized top (usually a shirt or sweater) that's long enough to cover most of the thighs, creating the illusion that they're not wearing pants or shorts underneath.

⁴ Strawberry marks (草莓印) - A Chinese slang term for hickeys/love bites, named because they resemble strawberries in color and appearance.